

August 20, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Morgan Gislason (MRN MUSC1901974), Claim MUSC-9AF8-4

Patient	Morgan Gislason (DOB 2007-12-15)
MRN	MUSC1901974
Member ID / Group	AMB513828945 / GRP-47184
Claim number	MUSC-9AF8-4
Date of service	2026-07-05
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$462.62
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-11-11

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of patient Morgan Gislason (MRN: MUSC1901974, Member ID: AMB513828945) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9AF8-4 for services rendered on July 5, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied on August 13, 2026, under CARC 16 with RARC N290, citing a missing or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full adjudication and payment of the claim. This appeal is being submitted within the applicable reconsideration and formal appeal deadlines, with a final appeal deadline of November 11, 2026.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Morgan Gislason is an 18-year-old established female patient with a documented history of recurrent upper respiratory conditions and active perennial allergic rhinitis. She presented on July 5, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22), for an outpatient evaluation and management visit. The encounter was billed under CPT 99214, representing an office or outpatient visit for an established patient with moderate complexity medical decision-making, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and a secondary diagnosis of R69. The visit was rendered by James H. Ferrell, MD, under Revenue Code 0510. The total billed amount for this single-unit service was \$462.62, against which Ambetter from Absolute Total Care has posted a payer-allowed amount of \$302.28 but remitted zero payment.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The payer's stated denial reason — "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid" — specifically references RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier was missing, incomplete, or invalid on the submitted claim. MUSC Health has reviewed the original claim submission and confirms that the rendering provider, James H. Ferrell, MD, holds National Provider Identifier 1992837465. This NPI is a valid, active Type 1 individual provider identifier issued through the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System and constitutes the required primary identifier for rendering providers on professional and institutional claims. To the extent any data element was omitted or formatted incorrectly in the original transmission, MUSC Health is resubmitting the claim with Dr. Ferrell's NPI 1992837465 clearly populated in the appropriate rendering provider field in accordance with standard claim submission requirements.

It is well established under HIPAA transaction standards and CMS claim completion guidelines that a technically deficient claim — one that can be corrected through the provision of missing or clarifying information — should be returned to the provider for correction or adjudicated upon receipt of the corrected submission, rather than denied outright without opportunity to cure. The payer's own remittance reflects an allowed amount of \$302.28, confirming that the service itself is a covered benefit under the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care PPO plan (Group GRP-47184, coverage period January 1, 2024 through December 31, 2026). There is no indication of a medical necessity dispute, a coordination of benefits issue, or any contractual exclusion applicable to this claim. The sole basis for non-payment is a correctable administrative deficiency, which MUSC Health has now remedied.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care reopen and reprocess Claim MUSC-9AF8-4 with the rendering provider NPI 1992837465 properly recognized, and issue payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$302.28 for the July 5, 2026 outpatient evaluation and management service provided to Morgan Gislason. Should the payer require any additional documentation — including a corrected claim, provider credentialing confirmation, or supporting encounter records — MUSC Health will respond promptly upon request through the secure provider portal.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record